

Chapter 31 Part 1

"You need to view films with an artistic eye" were words that came from Liang Shi's own mouth.

Now being lightly questioned back by Xu Qingzhu, especially with her clear and cold voice, the rising intonation at the end of her question, and the hint of a smile between her brows and eyes.

It was difficult to discern whether it was mockery or sarcasm.

Or perhaps just simple teasing.

In any case, it made Liang Shi's face flush with heat, even her ears turning red.

"Do you have anything else? I need to work." Xu Qingzhu was the first to break the silence, then added, "Can I use the computer in the study? I need to look at some design drafts."

Minghui Jewelry's annual new product launch was of paramount importance, and Xu Qingzhu's airborne arrival at the company coincided precisely with this year's autumn launch.

There were less than half a month remaining, and the design department had only finalized the preliminary drafts.

Due to Xu Guangyao's poor management, they had previously relied heavily on famous designer Qin Sisi as head of the design department. However, she jumped ship in the first half of the year, taking three of Minghui Jewelry's key talents with her and directly starting a new company. Although it didn't match Minghui Jewelry's reputation, it had already secured initial funding from venture capital companies and was beginning to make its mark in the industry.

Minghui Jewelry's design department was suddenly left without available talent. The current head of the design department had been transferred from the marketing department and didn't understand design at all.

The entire design department was in a state of panic. When Xu Qingzhu was parachuted in as deputy head, no one had faith in her.

Everyone knew that without renowned designers, Minghui Jewelry would soon reach a dead end.

The current Minghui Jewelry was merely at the end of its rope, unable to hold on much longer. What use was having the young lady parachute in?

Xu Qingzhu was just someone who studied finance.

What did she understand about design?

This year's autumn new product launch had reached the point of nearly falling through¹. Although the design department's dozen or so people were all working overtime, it was just ineffective overtime. Every draft they submitted was unusable - lacking novelty and not impressive. Forget comparing to Minghui Jewelry's work from decades ago; they couldn't even match recent years' standards.

It felt as though time kept moving forward while Minghui Jewelry had been ruthlessly left behind.

After Xu Qingzhu took office, the department head no longer bothered much with affairs.

He didn't really understand this aspect of things anyway. Normally in the office, he just slacked off and read books. After Xu Qingzhu arrived, he was perfectly content to be left in peace.

Moreover, Xu Qingzhu's attitude in the workplace was tough, and she was shrouded in the aura of being the company's young lady and future heir, quickly rallying people's hearts.

Although there were still quite a few who wanted to see her fail, most hoped she could bring vitality to the company.

After all, if Minghui Jewelry went bankrupt, they would all have to find new jobs.

But having people's hearts wasn't enough - you also needed capability.

In this regard, Xu Qingzhu wasn't completely hopeless.

Although she studied finance, her university was a top-tier domestic institution.

She hadn't been closed-minded during her studies and knew quite a few people.

She was currently actively contacting former friends to see if she could find suitable designers.

She was also using her years of accumulated keen sense for jewelry to oversee this autumn's new product launch, though it would be quite tiring.

Besides, this was inherently a high-stakes gamble.

In design-related fields, every new product was a high-stakes gamble.

You had to see whether the designer aligned with market trends, whether the designer's vision was unique, and whether you had the luck to hit upon suitable marketing.

Every step for a hit product had to go smoothly.

What Xu Qingzhu was taking over now was a complete mess. She even dreamed about jewelry design drafts at night.

Being able to still smile now could be considered making the best of a bad situation.

Liang Shi didn't yet understand her situation within the company and simply said, "Use it as you like, you don't need to ask me."

"Alright." Xu Qingzhu turned and walked around to the desk. Seeing that she still hadn't left, she glanced at the trash can. "Do you want this book?"

Liang Shi was startled and immediately waved her hands, "No need..."

She finished speaking and turned to leave.

But Xu Qingzhu called out to stop her, "Wait a moment."

Liang Shi turned back, "Ah?"

Xu Qingzhu retrieved the garishly covered book from the clean trash can, walked to the door and handed it to her. "This is your thing after all. It wasn't polite of me to throw it away carelessly. Sorry about that."

"It's fine, it's fine." Liang Shi said, "I wouldn't read it anyway."

"It's still yours." Xu Qingzhu stuffed the book into her arms, and Liang Shi immediately caught it. "Take it and read it. After all, judging a book based on just one passage isn't appropriate."

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Since it could be published, it must have its merits." Xu Qingzhu spoke seriously with calm eyes. "Though the writing in that passage wasn't great, it created very strong visual imagery."

Liang Shi: "?"

"No need..." Liang Shi said.

"Alright. I really need to work now." Xu Qingzhu said, "You don't need to wait for me to sleep. I probably won't finish until quite late."

Liang Shi looked at her and gave a reminder, "Get some rest early."

Xu Qingzhu had already sat down in front of the computer and put on her glasses, cold and distant.

But her focused expression was quite attractive.

Footnotes:

¹ "Opening the skylight" (開天窗) - A publishing/media industry term meaning to have blank space where content should be, essentially failing to deliver promised content on schedule.